



Cleft Lip and/or Palate Repair

Purpose: Surgical correction of a congenital split in the lip and/or roof of the mouth to improve appearance, speech, feeding, and overall function.

First 24–72 Hours:

- Swelling, mild bleeding, and discomfort are expected.
- Apply ice packs externally (if advised) to reduce swelling.
- Keep the head elevated while resting.

Pain & Sensitivity:

- Give prescribed pain medication and antibiotics exactly as directed.
- Mild irritability or feeding difficulties may occur in infants.

Oral Hygiene:

- Follow your surgeon's instructions for cleaning the surgical area.
- Use gentle rinses if prescribed; avoid brushing directly on sutures.

Diet:

- Infants may require specialized bottles or feeding techniques.
- Older children and adults should follow a soft or liquid diet as instructed.

Special Precautions:

- Prevent the child from putting fingers, toys, or other objects in the mouth.
- Use arm restraints if recommended to avoid touching the surgical site.
- Avoid strenuous activity until cleared by your surgeon.

Follow-Up:

- Multiple follow-up appointments are needed to monitor healing and speech development.
- Contact your surgeon if there is persistent bleeding, fever, swelling after 3 days, or feeding refusal.